

NICOLE + JASON

THE WEDDING EXHIBITION

Master Experience, Visual & Motion Design Brief

June 12, 2027 • The Barnes Foundation • Philadelphia

Purpose

A single source of truth for Fable to review the concept, challenge the interaction model, and translate it into a coherent spatial storyboard and motion system before production design or code.

North Star

“The information is the exhibition. The architecture is the navigation. The scroll is the walk.”

Nicole + Jason’s wedding website is a single continuous digital exhibition inspired by the architectural experience of the Barnes Foundation. Guests only scroll up and down, while the site interprets that vertical progress as a virtual camera moving vertically, horizontally, through depth, and occasionally visually upward.

The primary wedding sections are Exhibitions. Subsections within them are Galleries. Individual photographs, memories, events, locations, or pieces of information are Pieces/Moments. The presentation should feel intricate and technologically sophisticated while the visible interface remains minimal, modern, warm, and editorial.

Level	Meaning	Examples
Exhibition	Primary wedding website section	Our Story, The Wedding, The Weekend, Philadelphia, Gallery, Details, RSVP
Gallery	Subsection within an Exhibition	Ceremony, Cocktail Hour, Reception; Stay, Eat, Explore
Piece / Moment	Individual content object	Photo, illustration, memory, schedule item, hotel, map node

NICOLE + JASON

THE WEDDING EXHIBITION
AT THE BARNES FOUNDATION

A continuous scroll experience that transports guests through a series of beautifully curated exhibitions. Vertical scroll. Horizontal motion. Timeless story.

CORE PRINCIPLE



MOVEMENT LANGUAGE



DESIGN PILLARS

- Minimal
- Modern
- Architectural
- Editorial
- Immersive



01 LOADER / CONSTRUCTION SEQUENCE



- 01 A single point appears. 02 Technical lines assemble. 03 Architecture takes shape. 04 The space reveals itself. 05 You begin to walk forward.



02 EXHIBITION DIRECTORY (LOBBY)



EXPERIENCE FLOW MAP



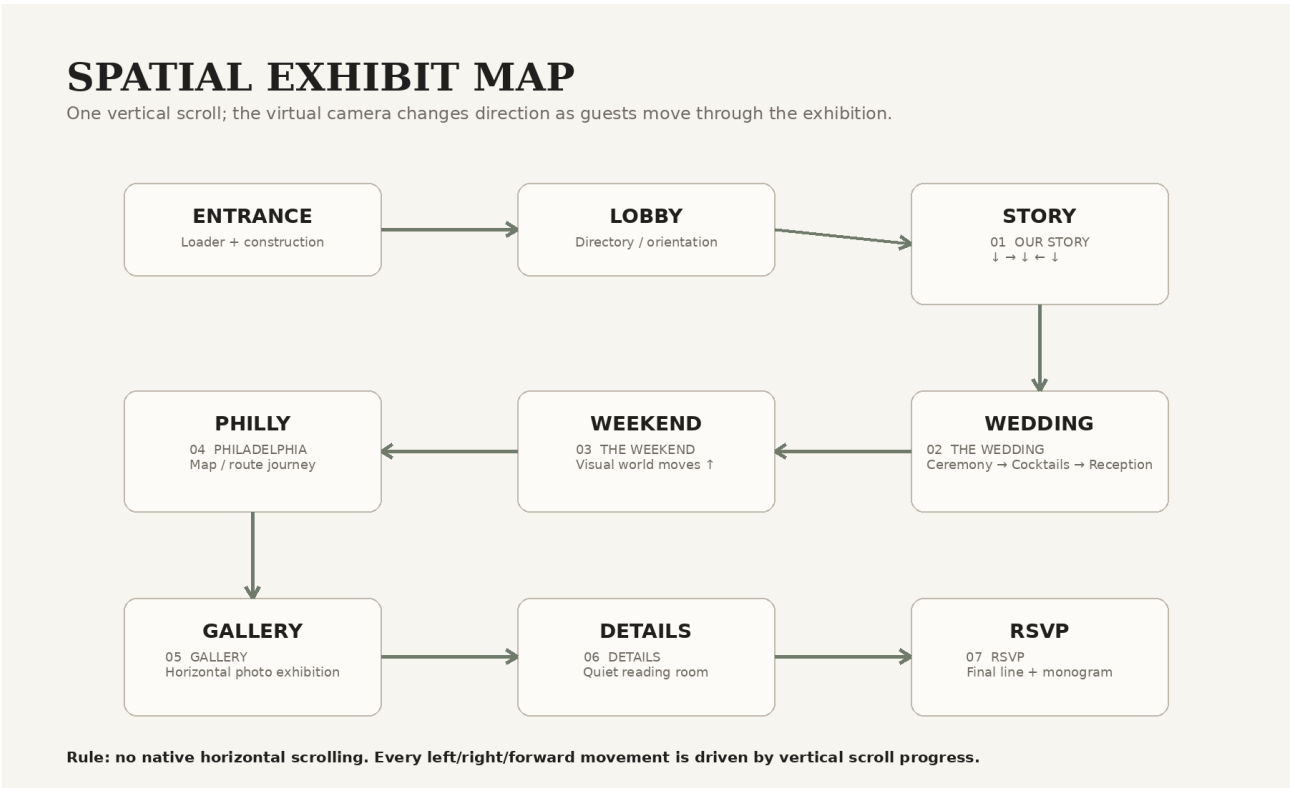
EXHIBIT JOURNEY WIREFRAME (SCROLL STORYBOARD)



Initial visual concept board: architectural minimalism, continuous-scroll exhibition hierarchy, responsive framing, and parallax system.

Top-level exhibitions

ID	Exhibition	Role in the wedding site	Primary spatial behavior
00	Entrance	Loader, identity, date, venue	Forward construction / depth
Lobby	Directory	Orient the guest and expose direct navigation	Slow forward approach
01	Our Story	Relationship timeline and illustrated memories	↓ → ↓ ← ↓
02	The Wedding	Ceremony, cocktails, reception	Long horizontal gallery →
03	The Weekend	Friday / Saturday / Sunday events	World moves visually ↑
04	Philadelphia	Stay, eat, explore, transportation	Route/map camera journey
05	Gallery	Photography and visual memories	Horizontal exhibition + image approach
06	Details	Attire, accommodations, transit, registry, FAQ	Static reading room
07	RSVP	Participation and completion	Quiet finale / line resolves



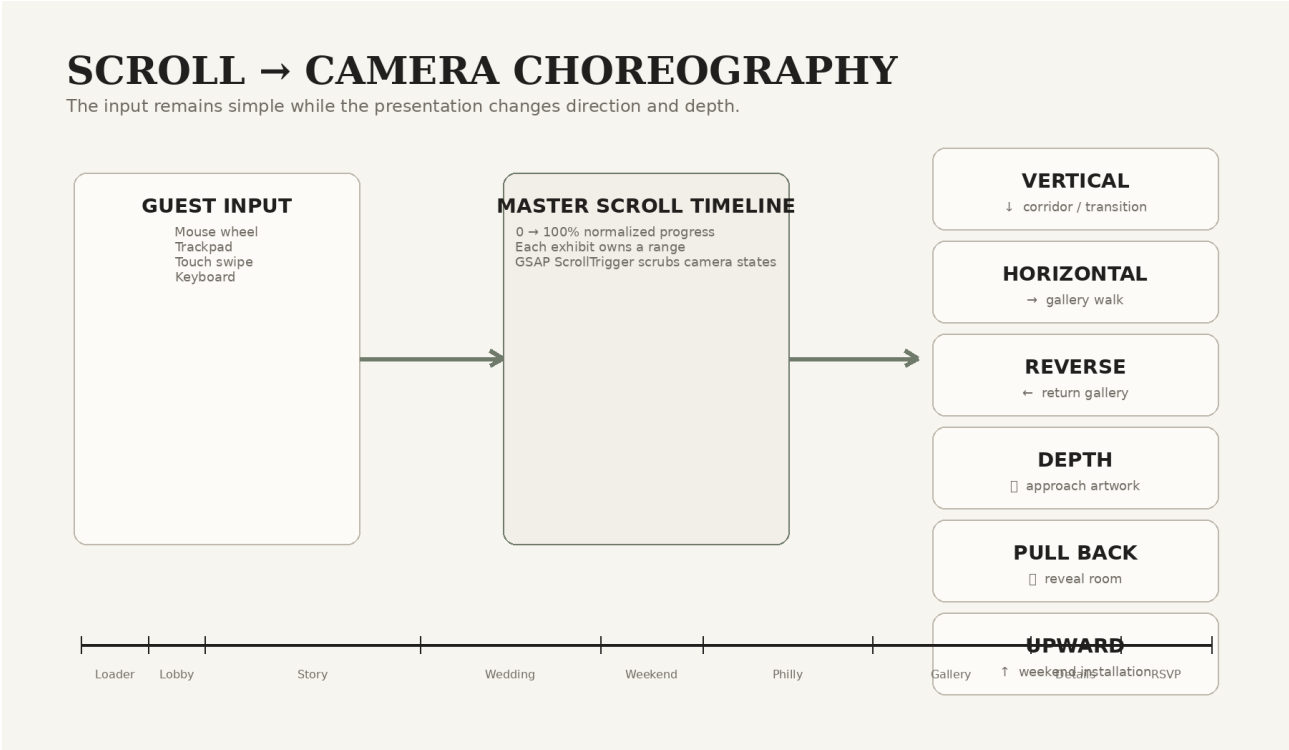
Spatial exhibit map: the page is linear internally, but the camera route behaves like interconnected rooms.

Critical interaction rule

There is no native horizontal scrolling. Mouse wheel, trackpad, touch swipe, and keyboard all advance the same vertical document timeline. Left/right/up/forward motion is presentation only.

One scroll, many directions

Treat the entire experience as one normalized progress value from 0 to 100%. Each Exhibition owns a range of that timeline and maps it to local camera choreography. The visitor always retains a simple vertical input model.



Input is simple; the master timeline maps scroll progress to direction, depth, pinning, and transitions.

Camera state	Visual intent	Typical use
Walk forward	Approach a wall, title, doorway, or artwork	Loader → Entrance; Lobby → Exhibit
Turn right / left	Make the user feel they changed rooms	Lobby → Story; Gallery transitions
Horizontal walk	Move along a wide exhibition wall	Our Story micro-gallery; The Wedding; Photo Gallery
Approach artwork	Bring one moment into focus	Engagement photo; Gallery focus
Pull back	Reveal that a full-screen image is hanging in a room	Exit Our Story; Gallery continuation
World moves upward	Create a distinct installation behavior without changing input	The Weekend

- Directional changes must be motivated by architecture: doorway, corner, wall, corridor, floor seam, map route, or artwork.
- Use foreground occlusion to hide scene swaps so transitions feel physically plausible.

- One dominant movement per moment. Secondary animation should support the camera, not compete with it.
- Scroll must feel directly connected to the user; avoid excessive smoothing or momentum that causes loss of control.

Loader: Signal → Geometry → Architecture → Invitation

The loader is the first signature experience and should establish the site’s technology without making the wedding feel futuristic or game-like. The visual reference is architectural plotting / generative construction, not a HUD, neon interface, Matrix code, or a spinner.

State	Visual	Scroll-driven behavior
A. Signal	Warm-white field; one tiny point	Point fades/scales into existence
B. Data	Subtle PHL/date/venue-coordinate metadata	Labels resolve around the point
C. Construction	Thin axes, vectors, rectangles, guide marks	Lines draw outward and connect
D. Perspective	Flat plan bends into a corridor	Scale/perspective establishes depth
E. Materialization	Warm stone/glass/wood/light replaces abstract linework	Architecture fades in while guides dissolve
F. Title	Nicole + Jason / The Wedding Exhibition / date / Barnes / Philadelphia	Camera settles; “scroll to enter” becomes active

Important

Do not force a long unskippable movie. If assets are ready, user scroll should immediately control the opening sequence. The loader is part of the page, not a blocking pre-roll.

Coordinate text should use the actual venue location when implemented. Do not hard-code illustrative coordinates from a mockup without verification.

The exhibition directory

The Lobby is the orientation moment. It proves that the museum vocabulary is the actual information architecture, not decoration. The directory should feel like discreet wayfinding on a contemporary gallery wall.

Persistent UI	Desktop	Mobile
Brand	N + J, top left	N + J, top left
Context	Exhibit number + name, top right	Compact exhibit indicator or menu
Menu	Bottom left or quiet top control	Hamburger / menu
Movement cue	Subtle arrow or progress cue	Optional minimal arrow
Direct access	Full-screen directory	Full-screen directory

- Selecting a menu item jumps/smoothly moves to that point in the same master timeline.
- A guest must never need to replay the story just to find attire, hotel, transit, or RSVP information.
- Keep the UI fixed while architecture moves behind it.
- Use real semantic navigation and visible keyboard focus states.

Our Story

This is the most intimate, narrative Exhibition and the primary home for Nicole + Jason's existing line-art identity. It can use the most varied directional choreography because it represents memory rather than logistics.

Gallery 01.01 — First Date

- September 2022.
- Sassafras, Philadelphia.
- Use actual SVG line art where possible so the scene draws progressively rather than using a raster wipe.
- Known micro-details can include Jason's Negroni and Nicole's tequila soda, but they should function as visual details rather than dominant copy.

Gallery 01.02 — Walk Home

- The line from the First Date artwork escapes the frame and becomes the path into the next scene.
- Old City references: cobblestone suggestion, street lamps, Philadelphia architecture, evening atmosphere.
- Layer foreground street/wall, midground Nicole + Jason, and background architecture for real parallax.

Micro-gallery — Early Memories

- Use a wide wall of smaller pieces instead of turning every memory into a full cinematic scene.
- Available story moments include Dogs Meet (October 2022), Thanksgiving, Hanukkah, early holidays, trips, life together, and other selected memories.
- Curate rather than automatically use every prior illustration.

Engagement — Feature Piece

- Quiet, singular installation near the end of Our Story.
- Potential transformation from line art into a real photograph to symbolize the transition from memory to the present.
- Do not invent engagement date/location/details that are not supplied.

Illustration continuity

Jason: short dark hair with gray at the sides, strong eyebrows, clean-cut, friendly smile.
 Nicole: long center-parted hair, hoop earrings, delicate necklace, warm smiling/laughing expression, slightly shorter than Jason. Maintain simplified SVG-friendly line weight and avoid heavy fills/shading.

Relationship artwork requirements

Subject	Continuity constraints
Jason	Short dark hair; gray at sides; strong eyebrows; friendly smile; clean-cut; avoid beard unless source demands it; hair should vectorize cleanly.
Nicole	Long center-parted hair; hoop earrings; delicate necklace; warm smile/laugh; slightly shorter than Jason.
Jagger	Mini Bordoodle / poodle mix; curly texture simplified into clean line art.
Cleo	Cocker spaniel; slimmer appearance; short/stubbed tail.
Style	Single-weight or visually consistent black line; white/transparent background; no shading; minimal fill; SVG-friendly; simple rather than photorealistic.

Recommended asset workflow: reference photo → simplified illustration → manual/vector cleanup → SVG → meaningful paths/groups → scroll-driven path reveal. Avoid over-detailed hair dots, dense hatching, or fills that become thick blobs during SVG conversion.

Recurring line motif

The same thin line should transform across the site: loader construction line → drawing stroke → street/floor seam → wedding architecture → weekend timeline → Philadelphia route → gallery detail → RSVP monogram.

The Wedding

This Exhibition shifts from personal illustration to formal architecture and event information. It should feel like one wide gallery containing three related installations: Ceremony, Cocktail Hour, and Reception.

Gallery	Visual temperature	Content behavior	Motion
02.01 Ceremony	Bright, formal, spacious	Date, venue, time, key ceremony details	Architecture assembles; pause at center
02.02 Cocktail Hour	Open, garden-adjacent, airy	Drinks, garden, music, transition information	Foreground wall/column reveals next room
02.03 Reception	Warmer, richer, celebratory	Dinner, dancing, reception details	Subtle velocity response; richer imagery

- Use an original simplified architectural interpretation of the Barnes rather than tracing copyrighted photography.
- The entire wedding gallery moves visually left-to-right as the guest scrolls down.
- Perspective and parallax should make the lateral motion feel like walking past installations, not a CSS carousel.
- Do not let Reception become nightclub/neon styling. The visual language stays restrained and elegant.

The Weekend

The Weekend intentionally reverses visual movement: the user scrolls down while a vertical schedule installation moves upward. Friday, Saturday, and Sunday pause at center long enough to read. Exact event content will be populated when finalized.

Philadelphia

A line exiting The Weekend develops nodes and becomes a stylized editorial map. The section should feel like navigating a diagram of the city rather than reading a travel guide or using a standard map embed.

Gallery	Content examples	Interaction
Stay	Hotel block / recommended accommodations	Camera arrives at Stay node; panel expands and collapses
Eat	Curated Philadelphia dining	Route shifts laterally/down to Eat node
Explore	Museums, Parkway, neighborhoods, activities	Node expands with imagery and concise recommendations
Transportation	Venue access and getting around	Route node or utility card; keep information highly readable

- The Barnes functions as a visual anchor on the route.
- Do not mimic Google Maps; prefer exhibition diagram / transit map / architectural cartography.
- Map movement can travel right, down, and diagonally while vertical scroll remains the only required input.

Gallery

The Photo Gallery is the most literal museum room, but it should not become a normal wedding photo grid. Images hang at varied sizes with editorial spacing. As a key image reaches the center, the camera can approach until it nearly fills the viewport, then pull back to reveal the wall again.

- Use automatic scroll focus for a curated subset of photographs.
- Tap/click can optionally open deeper sets, but essential progression should not depend on clicks.
- Prefer real photography; use masks, depth, focus, grain, and transition treatment instead of AI-restyling every image.

Details — The Reading Room

After the motion-heavy sections, Details should be intentionally calm. Treat it as a quiet reading room with minimal micro-interactions and accordion/expandable information for attire, accommodations, transportation, registry, and questions.

RSVP — Final Installation

The site becomes nearly empty. The point from the loader returns, draws the recurring line, and resolves into the Nicole + Jason monogram/mark. The RSVP form itself must remain straightforward and practical. After submission, close with “See you at the Barnes” and the wedding date.

Layered environments, not flat backgrounds

PARALLAX / DEPTH SYSTEM

Scenes are layered, not flattened. Relative movement creates the sensation of walking through architectural space.



MOVEMENT RULES

- Foreground passes fastest
- Background drifts slowly
- Content stays readable
- UI remains fixed
- Occluding walls hide scene changes
- Reduce layers on mobile
- Avoid simultaneous flashy effects

North star:
“The information is the exhibition.
The architecture is the navigation.
The scroll is the walk.”

Recommended depth architecture: different relative speeds create the sensation of moving through a room.

Layer	Role	Conceptual speed
01	Distant environment / light / far architecture	0.20×
02	Rear wall / architecture	0.50×
03	Primary content / artwork	1.00×
04	Near architecture	1.30×
05	Foreground wall / column / occluder	1.60–1.80×
UI	Navigation / exhibit context	Fixed

- Foreground elements passing rapidly across the viewport are one of the strongest cues that the user is physically walking.
- Do not flatten each room into one background JPEG. Separate meaningful layers whenever depth is part of the illusion.
- Lighting/texture can have scene-specific behavior, but should remain subtle.
- Wall/doorway occlusion is preferred for hiding scene changes.

Same exhibition, different choreography

RESPONSIVE CHOREOGRAPHY

Same story and hierarchy; different camera behavior for desktop, tablet, and mobile.

DESKTOP

Full spatial choreography

↓ □ →→→ ↓ ←← □ ↑
5 depth layers
Longer pinned galleries
Perspective turns

SAFE FOCUS AREA

TABLET

Moderated spatial choreography

↓ →→ ↓ ← □
3-4 depth layers
Shorter lateral runs
Reduced perspective

SAFE FOCUS AREA

MOBILE

Vertical-first choreography

↓ → ↓ ← ↓
2-3 depth layers
Content stays in safe focus area
No hover dependencies

SAFE FOCUS AREA

Accessibility baseline: semantic content, keyboard navigation, touch targets, real text, direct menu jumps, and prefers-reduced-motion fallback

Responsive rule: preserve narrative and spatial intent, not identical distances or layer counts.

Platform	Keep	Simplify
Desktop	Long horizontal galleries, 4-5 depth layers, stronger perspective turns, large photo approach sequences	Nothing purely for novelty; still protect readability
Tablet	Horizontal galleries, 3-4 layers, large photography, directory navigation	Shorten lateral distance and reduce extreme perspective
Mobile	Exhibit hierarchy, short lateral translations, depth cue, line motif, photo focus	2-3 layers, no hover dependency, shorter pins, less occlusion, fewer GPU-heavy effects

Mobile is not a fallback

The phone version should still feel like the same exhibition. It simply choreographs the virtual camera more conservatively so content stays legible and performant inside a narrow viewport.

Barnes-inspired, not Barnes-themed

Borrow the architectural feeling of the venue: strong geometry, warm natural materials, glass, garden adjacency, calm light, and generous space. Avoid literal replication of the Barnes collection, repetitive picture frames, fake ticket booths, “gift shop” jokes, or theme-park museum props.

Element	Direction
Palette	Warm limestone / ivory, stone, warm gray, near-black, restrained muted green
Display type	Elegant editorial serif for names, exhibition titles, major date statements
Interface type	Clean neutral sans/grotesk for numbering, labels, captions, navigation
Photography	Authentic, large, editorial; uncropped when practical; motion comes from presentation
Illustration	Simple clean line art; consistent weight; SVG-friendly; no heavy shading
Texture	Nearly invisible paper/stone grain; natural light; soft shadow
Corners / chrome	Mostly square / architectural; minimal UI ornamentation

- Avoid strong wedding pink, heavy gold, neon, tech-blue gradients, and decorative script as the primary typographic system.
- Handwritten/personal accents can appear sparingly as a human contrast to the architecture.
- Technology should be most visible during construction/loading and then recede beneath the experience.

Recommended implementation direction

Technology	Role
Next.js / React	Application shell, routing/section architecture, responsive content
GSAP ScrollTrigger	Master pinned/scrubbed scroll choreography
GSAP Flip	Artwork/photo expansion and return transitions
GSAP MotionPath	Continuous line and Philadelphia route behavior
SVG / path animation	Line illustrations, architecture, maps, monogram
CSS transforms / perspective	2.5D turns, layered room motion, occlusion
Lenis or equivalent	Optional light smoothing only if input remains precise
Three.js / R3F	Only for one or two moments if a browser-native 2.5D solution is insufficient

Do not architect the site as one enormous monolithic animation. Each Exhibit should own configuration for direction, scroll length, camera movement, layers, transition in/out, mobile behavior, and reduced-motion behavior. The master timeline coordinates those modular timelines.

Performance philosophy

Use modern effects aggressively only where they materially improve the spatial illusion. The finished site must feel premium on a real iPhone and Safari, not merely on a high-powered development machine.

Non-negotiables

- Responsive images and modern formats; never ship massive unoptimized photo assets.
- Lazy-load future Exhibitions; preload only the immediate next environment.
- Avoid huge autoplay video backgrounds unless a specific scene truly requires them.
- Simplify layer counts and perspective on less capable devices.
- Kill or pause inactive timelines where possible.
- Test iOS Safari, Android Chrome, desktop Safari/Chrome/Edge, trackpad, mouse wheel, and touch scrolling.
- Respect prefers-reduced-motion. Replace long camera flights with fades/gentle transitions while preserving all content.
- Use semantic text, adequate contrast, keyboard navigation, visible focus states, touch-friendly controls, and no critical hover-only interactions.
- No essential information should exist solely inside raster imagery.
- Optional audio must default OFF and the experience must work completely silently.

Starting allocation for prototyping

These percentages are a design starting point, not a locked production specification. Fable should validate pacing through storyboard/motion studies.

Range	Exhibition	Design intent
0–6%	Loader	Signal → geometry → architecture
6–11%	Entrance + Lobby	Identity + directory
11–30%	Our Story	Narrative and varied directional movement
30–46%	The Wedding	Long architectural horizontal gallery
46–55%	The Weekend	Upward installation
55–70%	Philadelphia	Map/route journey
70–84%	Gallery	Photo exhibition and focus
84–92%	Details	Quiet reading room
92–100%	RSVP + Finale	Point/line returns and resolves

Pacing test

A user who continuously scrolls should feel a coherent spatial journey, while a user who opens the menu should be able to jump directly to any practical section without losing access to content.

What this should not become

- A literal fake museum or theme park with ticket booths, gift shops, guards, and unnecessary museum jokes.
- A conventional wedding template with “Exhibit” labels pasted onto ordinary stacked sections.
- A portfolio site where every element performs a different effect.
- A WebGL demo where usability and readability are subordinate to graphics.
- A horizontal-scroll site that forces the guest to discover a new input method.
- A copy of the Barnes interior or its art collection.
- A generic beige luxury website with no distinct Nicole + Jason identity.
- A cyberpunk / HUD / Matrix “tech wedding” aesthetic.
- A site that requires the cinematic journey to locate time-sensitive practical information.

What Fable should challenge

1. Does the visitor genuinely perceive spatial navigation, or does it merely look like sections sliding sideways?
2. Can layered 2.5D architecture, perspective, and occlusion create convincing turns without a fully 3D site?
3. Which transitions should be perspective-based versus simple translation?
4. Which moments deserve sophisticated motion, and where should the design intentionally become still?
5. How should desktop choreography translate to tablet and mobile without simply scaling down?
6. How can the recurring line motif remain meaningful and integrated rather than decorative?
7. How should the loader move most naturally from abstract construction into a warm architectural environment?
8. How should the line-art relationship illustrations transition into architectural and photographic wedding sections?
9. Which interactions are likely to create performance, usability, scroll fatigue, or motion-sickness issues?
10. How can the Gallery feel spatial without a heavy 3D scene?
11. What exact camera movement should connect each Exhibition?
12. What visual decisions make the site unmistakably Nicole + Jason rather than simply “a museum website”?

Requested next deliverables

- Spatial floor plan showing all seven Exhibitions and their connections.
- Scroll map labeling camera direction, pinning, layer speeds, and transition mechanism for every segment.
- 20–30 keyframes covering the complete journey.
- Desktop / tablet / mobile choreography comparisons for the major transitions.
- Visual system proposal: type, materials, image treatment, numbering, navigation, line motif.
- Detailed loader motion study: point → data → geometry → architecture → entrance.
- One fully resolved prototype sequence: Our Story entrance → First Date → Walk Home → micro-gallery → exit.

Decision filter

Every proposed feature, animation, asset, or visual effect should pass the following checks:

Question	Pass condition
Does it reinforce the idea of walking through an exhibition?	Yes — it creates spatial continuity or clearer wayfinding.
Does it make wedding information easier to understand?	Yes — or it stays out of the way of practical content.
Does it feel modern and clean?	Yes — motion can be intricate while the visible interface remains quiet.
Does it feel specific to Nicole + Jason?	Yes — through story art, identity, photography, venue context, or the recurring line.
Does it work on mobile?	Yes — with responsive choreography rather than a degraded copy.
Would it still be elegant if the effect were slower and subtler?	Yes — avoid effects that depend on spectacle alone.

“The information is the exhibition. The architecture is the navigation. The scroll is the walk.”

End of master brief. This document should remain the source of truth until Fable returns a revised spatial storyboard and motion proposal.